

# Bharat Taxi is using AI, data and open networks

Will it change how people book rides in India?

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**O**ver the last few years, booking a taxi in India has changed a lot. Earlier, what used to be a task is now as easy as tapping a screen. While most of us just look at the price and how fast the car arrives, there is a lot of smart technology working in the background. This includes data science, AI, and digital maps that make every ride possible. Most big apps try to build every single piece of technology themselves. Whereas Bharat Taxi is taking a different path. Instead of starting from zero, they use open systems. This is like using high-quality shared tools to build a better house. They also work closely with local taxi owners across the country instead of competing against them.

To understand how this practical tech approach is changing long-distance travel, we sat down with Vivek Pandey. He is the Chief Operating Officer of Bharat Taxi. We talked about how technology can help drivers earn a steady and fair living. Along with that, we discussed using data and tracking to keep passengers secure.

## Pricing over algorithm?

When people hear about AI in ride-hailing, they often imagine complex routing systems or predictive demand engines. According to Vivek, the actual impact of data science begins at a

much more basic place. He said, 'data science primarily helps us in getting to the right pricing,' and he explained this by saying, 'we have teams inside the company, and they use AI to look at what's going on in the marketplace, what the right price is, and how different factors impact ride costs.'

The goal is not just to offer cheaper rides but rather to be about the balance. As he said, AI helps them analyse 'the right price both for the consumer and the driver'. This balance becomes important in a market where drivers often feel underpaid while customers remain sensitive to price hikes.

Bharat Taxi follows cost-based pricing, and by this, it is implied that they consider fuel costs, expected monthly payments (EMIs), maintenance costs, and a basic living cost for drivers. Using this information, the company can increase fares when fuel prices or other costs go up. You can also say that the system tries to reflect real-world economics instead of relying only on demand spikes.

## Pickup location accuracy

While many platforms highlight route optimisation as a key tech advantage, Vivek believes that is not where the real differentiation lies. He said that 'everyone in the ecosystem uses

available maps.' He further added that 'whether it is us or anyone else, the routes are coming from the same mapping systems.'

Because of this, route suggestions for most trips, especially shorter ones, tend to be quite similar across platforms. Vivek explained that the available maps already factor in traffic and give the best route.

He further explained that instead of focusing on something that is standardised, 'Bharat Taxi is putting its efforts into improving the pinpoint accuracy of the pickup location.' As more users book rides from

the same spots, the system starts recognising exact entry points, building names, and common pickup markers.

This has a direct impact on user experience. Riders do not have to explain their location repeatedly, and drivers spend less time circling around or calling for directions. In a category where small delays can quickly frustrate users, this focus on improving real-world pickup precision may matter more than adding another layer of route optimisation.

## Drivers have more control

One of the most distinct aspects of Bharat Taxi is its cooperative structure. Drivers, who are also known as 'sarathi', can become members by purchasing shares.

Vivek explained that while this is not mandatory, it changes how a Sarathi interacts with the platform. He added that 'the sense of ownership increases a lot as they become co-promoters of the platform.' **d**



**Vivek Pandey**  
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